

Dysprosium

66
Dy

Compared to other lanthanides, this element reacts more easily with oxygen and water. Its name means “hard to get at”; the metal was purified for the first time only in the 1950s.

ATOMIC MASS 162.5

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1886

(Paul-Émile Lecoq de Boisbaudran)

**Laboratory sample of
pure dysprosium**



Holmium

67
Ho

The lanthanide holmium is named after the Swedish capital Stockholm, which is called “Holmia” in Latin. It is used in the making of some medical lasers. Holmium lasers are hot enough to burn through skin – surgeons and dentists use them to make delicate cuts that heal quicker than traditional surgical cuts.

ATOMIC MASS 164.93

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1878 (Marc

Delafontaine and Louis Soret),
1878 (Per Teodor Cleve)

**Black crystals of gadolinite,
an ore of holmium**

